



Doyen of the game: Chandu Borde made 55 Test appearances and had a double of over 3,000 runs and 50 wickets. After retiring from the game, he contributed as chief selector, India's team manager, and even a match referee. EMMANUAL YOGINI

miserably in the (ODI) World Cup [in the West Indies], and there was unpleasantness among the players, so I was appointed.

Which role have you found the most enjoyable yet challenging?
A cricketer's, of course. Particularly

against the West Indians. We never saw that kind of bowling during our cricketing period, and they used to bowl from 18 yards because the front foot (no-ball) rule was not applicable then. We had no helmet or elbow guard.

The thigh pad was very thin. Sometimes, we used to put gloves inside pads. That was quite frightening. But I played some challenging cricket [during the West Indies tour of India in 1958/59]. I scored a hundred [in the first innings] in the Delhi Test but missed out on one in the second innings [he was dismissed for 96]. From then on, I

enjoyed playing against all countries.

Do you have any regrets?

Regrets were few, or quite a bit. And very disheartening. Once I was told that I was going to lead the side the next day, and then in the morning, somebody else came in as the captain. Once the chairman [of the selection committee] came to Vidarbha, where I was playing a match and the team was selected. Though I was padded up and ready to bat, I was asked to remove all those things, and I was out of the XI. But when I look back, I think whatever happened, happened for